the daughter would feed and water a few sheep, while her brother released his flock of pigeons from their cages to search the city for scraps. He had trained them to follow a huge chequered flag, and I used to love to watch him waving this flag against the sky like some Grand Prix starter, while the call to prayer rose from mosque to citadel and the sun lit the haze into a furnace.

By Christmas 2007, we had a number of successes – or *succès de scandale* – under our belts. Fallujah and Guantánamo had brought too little attention, given the size of the leaks, and we continued to add to the Kenyan revelations. I attended the 24th Chaos Communication Congress in Berlin, which allowed me to meet some of the people I'd been chatting to or otherwise dealing with online. Among these was an excitable fan of our work called Daniel Domscheit-Berg, a systems company employee who soon proved useful for some tasks. From the beginning, Daniel Schmitt, as he was referred to then, was a curious asset. He couldn't write code, but he could prove dutiful to the needs of the growing organisation. We couldn't have guessed then how ambitious or how reckless he would become. But need is blind when it comes to volunteers, and we badly required as much help as we could get.

The Chaos Computer Club, which organised the convention in Berlin right at the end of 2007, is famous for good reasons and bad ones. They are a hackers' organisation, founded in 1981 to campaign for technological progress, openness, freedom of information and free public access to technology. They quickly grew from their origins in Berlin and they are now a powerful, cross-border organisation that keeps a close eye on how information technology is being used and abused in contemporary societies. They have protested against French nuclear testing and against the use of biometric data in passports, but others of the group, led by Karl Koch, were arrested for cyber-espionage activities in the late '80s, including taking material from corporate and government computers in the US and feeding it to the KGB.

That wasn't our bag. We admired the brainpower in the group and supported its broad efforts to question how information was used, but WikiLeaks never saw itself as an organisation that would campaign for one ideology against another, or for one nation against others. Inside the organisation, we are a broad church and our enemies are, in each case, and everywhere, the enemies of truth. We accepted no piety when it came to the